PATIENT CASE FILE

FILE NO. 1428-A STATUS: ACTIVE ACCESS: RESTRICTED

PATIENT	[redacted] , **ALBUS**
DATE OF BIRTH	[redacted]
PRESCRIBING PHYSICIAN	**MORRISON, F., M.D.**
DISPENSING PHARMACY	**WESTBROOK COMPOUNDING PHARMACY (118 MI)**
INDICATION	[redacted]

MEDICATION HISTORY

AGE 5-13	**HYPNOCIL 500 MG QHS**	DISCONTINUED BY MANUFACTURER
AGE 13-PRESENT	**LEVERAZOPAM 500 MG QHS**	ACTIVE -- NON-FORMULARY
CLASS	**ONEIROSUPPRESSANT**	
NOTE	DO NOT SUBSTITUTE. DO NOT INTERRUPT. TITRATION NOT APPLICABLE.	

CLINICAL NOTES

PROVIDER ACCESS ONLY

[redacted] does not present at father's residence [redacted]

[redacted] no recurrence of the [redacted] since age 5. [redacted]

ATTACHMENT A -- SCREENPLAY RECOVERED FROM PATIENT RESIDENCE

PRECAUTIONS

written by

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INT. BATHROOM - DAY

Cramped hallway bath. Steam on mirror.

ALBUS (17) wipes a streak clear. Studies reflection. Gaunt and pale. Something terminal about him. Bags heavy under eyes.

Opens his mouth. Tongue is hamburger meat: chewed, swollen, crusted with dried blood. A tooth ache on the pain scale and as consistent: every syllable is a sting. The lisp that follows is protective.

Touches it. Winces immediately, even the air stings.

Brows curl, confused. Looks down at his body, inspects while shaking his head. Lifts an arm. Behind it: RED SCRATCH MARKS. Deep enough to scab.

INT. KITCHEN - LATER

DANIELA (40s) stands at the counter, knife working through onions. Smells like sofrito.

Bathroom door opens. Albus slugs out, zipping up a hoodie. Without turning around--

DANIELA
Good morning, Papi.

ALBUS
Hi.

DANIELA
Smell that? You hungry?

Slurs his words, slow and careful.

ALBUS
I don't wanna eat.

She hears the lisp, concern's on 10. Turns to him:

DANIELA
How'd you sleep?

Hold on him. Tired of this conversation. Tired, in general.

ALBUS
Fine.

DANIELA
Show me. Open your mouth.

Shakes his head. Face has a dry anger.

DANIELA (CONT'D)
No. Show me.

Deadpan. Obeys after a beat: sticks his tongue out again. Daniela closes her eyes, frustration and fear brewing.

DANIELA (CONT'D)
You need to do your part, Albus. You don't wear your mouthguard at night. You need to take your medicine. You know this. You're almost 18. C'mon now.

Albus avoids eyes. Chooses his words carefully, tries to keep his tongue still.

ALBUS
How you know?

DANIELA
Because you're my son. And because as long as you take your medicine, you sleep fine.

Holds him silent for a beat. Uprising in his throat, until:

ALBUS
I want to see a neurologist.

Makes her hairs stand. Like an alibi being poked. Catches herself--

DANIELA
Okay. That's okay. That's fine. I'll make an appointment with Dr. Morrison.

Shakes his head, teenage disappointment.

ALBUS
No. Somebody else. Anybody else.

DANIELA
What's wrong with Dr. Morrison?

ALBUS
Ma, the dude is weird.

DANIELA
Weird how?

ALBUS
Like he's one of them talk-therapy type, not a real MD. And that's what I need. Someone who knows shit.

DANIELA
Language.

ALBUS
Sorry.

DANIELA
Well he does "know shit." He's been your doctor since you were little.

Tension builds in his face. Pain births rebellion.

ALBUS
I can't live like this and not know.

Daniela's resolve holds but cracks.

ALBUS (CONT'D)
Every time I don't take that pill... I always wake up with blood in my mouth. Always. And when I tell him...? *Oh, that's interesting. Did you get any déjà vu that day or day before?* Like, how does that help me?

Winces from pain. Swallows.

ALBUS (CONT'D)
I just want to know what's wrong with me. Get an MRI, something.

DANIELA
There's nothing wrong with you. Don't talk like that.

ALBUS
Stop gaslighting me, Ma. Please.

DANIELA
I'm serious. It's not--

ALBUS
Look at me!

Points at his mouth.

ALBUS (CONT'D)
I can't eat. Can't drink nothing. And it only gets worse. I feel like one day I'm gonna wake up with my tongue on the floor.

DANIELA
I just don't understand, Albus... I know that the tongue bites hurt... and I know that you don't like wearing your mouth guard. But you don't get these attacks when you take your medicine, right?

ALBUS
(a beat)
No.

DANIELA
So what's the problem, my love? If these... bites, impact you the way that you say they do... why don't you just take the medicine?

Face vibrates still. Eventually:

ALBUS
Because of what it does to me.

DANIELA
It helps you sleep. That's it.

ALBUS
That's not it. And no, it doesn't help me sleep, either.

DANIELA
What do you mean?

She's on 10, slight pause feels an eternity--

DANIELA (CONT'D)
Albus. What do you mean? What happened?

ALBUS
I get these crazy thoughts. Putting the power-drill through my temple. It's like... it's me but it's not. I don't die... but I don't feel good about it.

DANIELA
Jesus, Albus. How long has this been happening?

ALBUS
Since you switched my pills.

Silence. Onions SIZZLE behind her.

DANIELA
Explain this to me, Albus. Because I don’t understand.

ALBUS
These little white pills you give me, Ma. They fuck me up. I know it’s that.

Thinks back, comes up with answers:

DANIELA
Wait a second. You’ve been on Leverazopam since you were 13. You mean to tell me that you’ve been having these thoughts since you were 13?

ALBUS
It didn’t happen right away.

DANIELA
Baby... why is this the first time that I’m hearing about this?

ALBUS
I’ve told you before.

DANIELA
No. You told me you feel gray occasionally. A day or two. But no you never told me you dream about killing yourself.

ALBUS
I miss the other one I used to take. The blue one.

DANIELA
United doesn’t cover the Hypnocil anymore.

ALBUS
What’s the difference?

DANIELA
Nothing. Leverazopam does the same thing.

ALBUS
(remembers)
Leverazopam. You know, I asked Chatty what that was. It asked me if I meant *lorazepam.* I was looking at the bottle as I typed it.

DANIELA
Leverazopam is a medication that helps with what you have. It protects you from biting your gums and tongue.

ALBUS
And the scratches?

DANIELA
You have scratches? Where?

Silence. Albus unsure how much he wants to share. Then:

Pulls up his sleeve. Turns his arm, those RED SCRATCH MARKS, exposed in the kitchen light.

Daniela's eyes pop like an adrenaline crank. Puts the knife down and feels the marks like braille. Voice cracks:

DANIELA (CONT'D)
When was this?

ALBUS
Last night. This morning. I don't know.

Traces the marks. Face breaks down.

DANIELA
You're not going to school, tomorrow. We're going to schedule an appointment first thing in the morning.

ALBUS
Okay. Can we go to the hospital instead?

DANIELA
Albus, scratches like this are exactly why you should still be on your medicine.
(MORE)

DANIELA (CONT'D)
I'm not dismissing what you told me. But this is... sudden. My goodness, do they hurt?

ALBUS
Not anymore.

Daniela's devastated. Somehow, it's a familiar dread... Not quite this but:

DANIELA
Baby... did you go anywhere in your sleep?

ALBUS
What? like sleepwalking?

DANIELA
Could be anything. Do you remember coming to my room at night? Telling me you saw uh...

ALBUS
What?

DANIELA
(pivots)
A bird, or something.

ALBUS
You're lying.

DANIELA
Excuse me?

ALBUS
You can't lie for shit, mother. You just think you can.

DANIELA
I'm not lying.

ALBUS
Forget it.

DANIELA
No. please.

ALBUS
I'm gonna spend a few days over at dad's. Because I hate these pills and I want to know why I have to take them every day.

DANIELA
(after a beat)
If that’s what you have to do. I support it.

ALBUS
Great.

Walks off. Heads for the door. She holds her breath, best she can. But nope:

DANIELA
Your father’s never had to deal with the tough nights. Doesn’t hear the tears. Doesn’t have to drive 2 hours to West Bubblefuck to get this one medication that does God knows what, but keeps you asleep through the whole night.

ALBUS
And what happens in my sleep when I don't?

DANIELA
You bite yourself. You scratch yourself.

ALBUS
Why?

DANIELA
Because that’s what happens when you don’t.

He stares at her, dumbfounded. Laughs, actually. Causing his tongue to STING. He grabs his mouth, sober.

ALBUS
Text you when I’m at dad’s.

Steps out. Door clicks shut.

Daniela doesn’t move. Smoke collects over the pan. Fire alarm SNAPS her out of it.

Without thinking, reaches for the handle barehanded.

Skin sizzle. Winces mute. Turns the tap on, rinses it underneath.

INT. LIVING ROOM - NIGHT

Dim. Daniela on the couch, scrolling.

PHONE SCREEN: GoodRX. LEVERAZOPAM 500 mg. $680/30 Days. One pharmacy listed.

Stares at it. Thinks for a beat, types--

Hypnocil.

The result loads: HYPNOCIL 500MG — DISCONTINUED. No pharmacies available.

Grits her teeth. Stares at the screen.

A KNOCK at the door.

INT. LIVING ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

Opens the door--

DR. MORRISON. 70s, Glover looks. Steps in.

DANIELA
Thank you so much for coming.

MORRISON
It’s no trouble.

DANIELA
Can I get you anything? Coffee, water?

MORRISON
No thank you.

DANIELA
(after a beat)
I don’t know what to do.

MORRISON
What happened?

DANIELA
He caught me in a lie tonight. Going to his father’s. When he’s there he stops taking it. I know he will. So I need to--

MORRISON
Daniela.

DANIELA
--keep the records how they are. If a new doctor calls your office--

MORRISON
This isn't the way.

DANIELA
Excuse me?

MORRISON
He told you what the pill is doing to him?

DANIELA
You knew?

Nods, guiltily. Daniela shakes her head *what the hell, man?*

MORRISON
I advocated for him to tell you every session. But I couldn't cross that line. I'm sorry.

DANIELA
I don't know what to do.

MORRISON
If I'm being honest, Daniela... I think this conversation needed to happen a long time ago. He deserves some answers.

DANIELA
Know *what,* doctor?

A beat. Almost laughs like her son.

DANIELA (CONT'D)
I've been doing this song and dance for years, and you still can't tell me what it is. So what do I tell him? A question mark?

Recalls her earlier conversation:

DANIELA (CONT'D)
Says he wants an MRI. What do I tell him?

MORRISON
It won't show anything. If it helps.

DANIELA
(recites from memory)
The pill just works. That's what I know. That's all I know.

MORRISON
He doesn't get attacks at his father's you said? It may be the best place for him, until we can stabilize him.

Eyes scan surrounding. Ceiling, walls. What's dirt, what's mold.

DANIELA
I will not lose my son, Dr. Morrison.

CUT TO BLACK.